

THE BUTTERFLY EFFECT

Written by

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FADE IN:

INT. MATERNITY WARD - DAY

The maternity ward has an array of hospital bassinets, filled with children of all races and ethnicities. On the window sill of the room a butterfly flies in and lays 4 eggs. Immediately one of the eggs starts to prematurely wriggle as a young black baby starts crying. The name on the babies bassinet reads THEO JAGUAR".

THEO JAGUAR (V.O.)
Hey, I know I'm the last
person you expected to
hear from. But I need you
to send out a message to
the people. They'll have
a lot to say about me.
But I need them to know
why I did it.

INT. JAGUAR MANSION - DAY

THEO JAGUAR JR. (13, gangly, light skinned, perm with a black fade) is sitting with his father Theo Jaguar SR. (45, Athletic Build, Dark skinned) in a bedroom. Young Theo's mother MADELINE JAGUAR (Very light skinned, curly short hair, petite) is standing in front of him with a camera in hand. Beside her is CHARLOTTE JAGUAR (17, tall, light skinned). Madeline clicks and the camera begins recording.

MADELINE JAGUAR (V.O.)
And go.

THEO SR.
Sorry honey. I'll be honest, I
totally forgot, what am
I supposed to be asking him?

Theo sr. And Theo both look at each other and start laughing.

THEO JR.
For school baba, you're supposed
to ask me what I want to be when I
grow up.

THEO SR.
Right. What do you want to be
when you grow up my boy?
(MORE)

THEO SR. (CONT'D)

Theo looks at his dad excitedly and then the camera.

THEO JR.

A hero!

Theo Jr. gives a big gap-toothed smile.

INT. YOUNG THEO JAGUAR BEDROOM - NIGHT (FLASHBACK)

Theo Jr. sits in a buddha position wearing regal attire. Behind him is his sister whispering into his ears. He looks at her nods and closes his eyes. A dark aura starts to come out of him and he starts floating.

THEO JAGUAR (V.O.)

I want to start this story off with something my grandma once told me. She said, "when god created mankind, he made them in the likeness of god". I thought to myself if we're like god do we get his loneliness. Is ours only a fraction of his own?

INT. CRONOS EVACUATION FACILITY - DAY

Theo Jr. is inside of a pod banging on the glass in a panic. Theo's older sister Charlotte Jaguar dressed in a high tech wetsuit) comes up to the glass and mouths some words to young Theo.

CHARLOTTE JAGUAR

(Inaudible)

I love you.

THEO JAGUAR (V.O.)

When I was a boy it used to make me really sad for him. So I would pray to cheer him up. I wanted him to know he wasn't alone. I loved him.

Charlotte holds up a butterfly pendant to Theo and mouths something to him again.

CHARLOTTE JAGUAR
(Audible)
Always remember.

Theo Jr. starts freaking out and crying inside of the pod. He closes his eyes and tears start to well up. A black substance begins to form around him.

THEO JR.
Charlotte no! I don't wanna be out
there alone!

Charlotte does a hand movement and a yellow aura surrounds the pod. The black substance subsides and Theo becomes more relaxed. She then hits a button that blasts Young Theo into the water. Theo Jr. looks through the glass and sees a giant explosion happen.

THEO JAGUAR (V.O.)
Sadly, tragic events changed my
opinion of my one time friend. I
had to face the truth. I am
crushingly alone in a society of
utter chaos and I feel lost.

He stares ahead as tears fill up his eyes and he begins sobbing. His pod floats away in silence.

THEO JAGUAR (V.O.)
The isolation in that pod. In this
life. It's too much to bear. It
makes you feel desperate for the
slightest reassurance. There are
people in this world who sense that
and take advantage of it.

Montage: Theo Jr. is found by a submarine. He is taken to an underwater dome city with the name Zemaculeas. Theo is placed inside an orphanage. He sees all the children playing and immediately goes to a secluded area of the orphanage and sees two kids sitting in silence staring at him. Kiara (Dark skin, fulani braids, olive green eyes) and Elijah (tribal tattoo, brown eyes, short) who wears headphones over his ears. Kiara makes a gesture to call Theo over. Theo makes his way over to them and sits down.

THEO JAGUAR (V.O.)
But you gotta take responsibility
for your mistakes and know the road
to hell is paved with good
intentions.

(MORE)

THEO JAGUAR (V.O.) (CONT'D)

The truth is suffering and isolation are our connective tissues and my pain wasn't greater than anyone else's. I just couldn't see it.

INT. ORPHANAGE - DAY

Theo is on the floor of the orphanage playing with a young child. He notices a young woman with golden hair and stares at her. RUTH MAZNIKE (25, dark skin, heterochromia) meets his gaze in an intimidating way and he quickly looks away. She walks over to the matron of the orphanage OPHELIA MICHTONIC (60'S, Dark-Skinned).

RUTH MAZNIKE

You're short again this month.

OPHELIA

Times are tough. Please Ruth I need more time.

RUTH MAZNIKE

The crown has been very forgiving of your various debts Ms. Ophelia. We are starting to lose patience. Running this little show doesn't exempt you from paying what you owe.

Ophelia drops to her knees and looks up at Ruth.

OPHELIA

I understand. Please just give me some more time. Do my years of service mean nothing.

Ruth stares down at Ophelia in disgust. Ruth spits in her face.

RUTH MAZNIKE

Ungrateful Traxulom. Your service isn't a bargaining chip to relieve yourself of your debts. We all must pay our dues.

Ophelia begins uncontrollably sobbing. Kiara and Elijah run toward her and embrace her. They look up at Ruth whose looming figure stands un-phased before them.

OPHELIA

(Pleading)

Please Ruth! If not for me. Have
mercy on the children.

Ruth looks at Kiara and then around at all the children of
the orphanage who are staring at her.

RUTH MAZNIKE

I don't much care for future
beggars and criminals Ophelia. As
of today your little orphanage has
lost the crown's protection.

Ruth walks out of the orphanage and whistles. Three figures
in white cloaks make their way into the room. They stand
staring at Ophelia and the children. Ophelia has a sad look
in her eyes. Tears begin streaming down her face.

EXT. ORPHANAGE. - NIGHT

THEO Jr. sits on a hill at the precipice of the wreckage. A
vacant look in his eyes he stares ahead. YOUNG KIARA and
YOUNG ELIJAH flanking his sides. Elijah snuffles beside him,
Kiara squeezes his shoulder. There's not much left of the
orphanage save for billowing black smoke and a toppled
building. The robot emergency crews are cleaning up the
scene, pattering away at their jobs. The Royal Guard circles
the perimeter, keeping the general public at bay. Theo and
his friends are well enough away from the scene that they
remain unnoticed.

Theo's eyes look away from what was once his home and
locks his gaze with YOUNG TIBERIUS (16, lean, stoic)
displaying the Royal Families insignia. A cold robotic hand
clasps Theo's shoulder, who turns around, startled. It's a
bionic YOUNG MAN (early 30s, one cybernetic eye, one robotic
arm) who beckons all three children to follow him in silence.
Kiara grips Theo's arm and Elijah does the same, the three
forming a link as they follow the young man away from the
crowd.

Tiberius fists tighten at his sides as he watches the scene
before him. He is surrounded by the Royal Guard and joined by
his two siblings, YOUNG ZADOK (14, dark skinned) with a
mischievous look on his face and YOUNG YARA (8) shyly looking
away from the people around. An ADVISOR comes over to
Tiberius to whisper something in his ear.

ADVISOR

Look upon your people, my king.
They look to you for guidance.

Tiberius breathes deeply and fixes his gaze upon the forming crowd of the public. He manages a strained smile.

EXT. CITY STREETS - CONTINUOUS

The orphans get into a flying rickshaw with the young man and drive all the way through the city into a dimly lit street, with the flashing neon of a sign displaying "Kyoka's Noodles" Once they've touched down the young man beckons the children to follow him inside. With reluctant gazes to one another, the orphans follow.

INT. KYOKA'S NOODLES - CONTINUOUS

There is barely a look inside before the children are swept up quickly into a back room and down echoing marble stairs infused with circuitry.

INT. BASEMENT - CONTINUOUS

The young man does a hand movement with his robot arm that lights up some circuitry and opens up a secret door to a vast space. No more than 10 or 15 men, women, and children altogether sit wide-eyed, with blankets covering their shaking figures. The young man gently leads the three orphans to join the mass, handing each of them a blanket as well.

YOUNG MAN

You'll be safe here. Don't worry.

THEO JAGUAR

Safe from who.

The young man looks at a screen in a corner of the room.

YOUNG MAN

Them.

With that, the young man goes back upstairs. The orphans look at the screen and Theo once again sees young Tiberius. This time he is standing atop a podium.

EXT. ORPHANAGE WRECKAGE - NIGHT

Floating cameras blasting with reporter holograms beside them asking a bevy of questions surround the stage where A Young Tiberius stands tall.

He snaps his fingers and a prompter appears with his speech prepared. He clears his throat, the cameras still clicking and snapping.

YOUNG TIBERIUS

My sympathies go out to those
affected by last night's
attacks. We are doing everything
we can to keep the peace.

Tiberius looks down and clears his throat. He then looks back up to continue his speech.

YOUNG TIBERIUS (CONT'D)

In Zamaculeas. However, these
were terrorist attacks.

Tiberius pauses before reading the next lines on the prompter, he stares ahead stoically before reading the next lines.

YOUNG TIBERIUS (CONT'D)

We are urging every citizen to
remain cautious and be on the
lookout for any forming
organizations that may threaten
our livelihood. If you have any
information or concerns, please
contact the capitol police.
That will be all. Thank you.

Tiberius leaves the stage, despite the growing noise of protests from the reporters asking for more. An advisor's arm wraps around his shoulder.

ADVISOR

Very good, my king.

SUPERIMPOSE: "KINGDOM OF ZEMACULEAS. YEAR 3005."

SUPERIMPOSE: "30 DAYS: 12 HOURS: 10 MINUTES: 40 SECONDS: TO
CIVIL WAR."

EXT. ZEMACULEAS STREET - DAY

The street is bustling full of different poor people selling foods at a market. Some begging for Zemaculean currency. Some laughing and speaking with each other in their mother tongue.

In an empty area a young man is being held by two police officers. The THIRD POLICE OFFICER (Light Skinned, 6'2, Afro) is beating him as his DAUGHTER (Dark skinned, red hair) and WIFE (Dark skin) watch.

THIRD POLICE OFFICER
Damn Traxulom scum, don't you ever
question my authority again. Do
you know what happens to people
who defy the crown.

WIFE
(Pleading)
Officer please.

DAUGHTER
Daddy!!!

The mans face is bloodied and bruised. The third officer gives him a smug look before getting ready to throw another punch. A singular crow flies onto the shoulder of officer three and caws. Officer three notices the crow has a piece of paper tied to it's leg and takes it and unfurls it.

INSERT: Officer three opens up the note, the Black Cloak Society insignia all over it. There are crude caricatures of the royal family and symbols of justice. Written in bold letters are: "Zemaculeas must know darkness before it can see true light"

Two more crows fall onto the shoulders of officers one and two and start to caw. Crows then suddenly fly down onto the empty street. Suddenly the police officers hear a rustling and look around. A hooded figure is walking slowly towards them. Police officer 3 speaks to him.

POLICE OFFICER THREE
Hey you, this is the official
business of the crown. Disperse
immediately.

The figure continues to walk towards the officers. The two officers grabbing the man drop him to the ground. All three men grab their weapons and move towards the figure.

POLICE OFFICER THREE (CONT'D)
This is your final warning.

The officers begin firing at the hooded figure and the bullets seem to dissolve once they reach the figure. The figure does a movement with their hands and black sludge comes from beneath the officers. They try to move away but find themselves stuck. The figure moves towards the bloodied young man and his wife and daughter.

They cower before him. THEO JAGUAR (23, Close set hazel eyes, Athletic body, bronze skin. More curly hair with a black fade) removes his hood and smiles at the family.

THEO JAGUAR
It's okay. You're safe now.

Theo pulls out a cloth and wipes the blood off the mans face. He then looks at the wife and daughter. He smiles at them both and reaches out his hand to the little girl.

THEO JAGUAR (CONT'D)
Come with me. We'll get your dad
all fixed up and make sure you and
your mom are taken care of.

Officer three starts laughing and mocks Theo.

POLICE OFFICER THREE
You've just fucked yourself over
kid. The Argus was definitely
watching. Officers are going to be
swarming this place in no time

Theo looks at the officer and chuckles.

THEO JAGUAR
We're not too worried about that.
Right Elijah.

Two other hooded figures with the black cloak insignia than come out from the shadows and take off their hoods. ELIJAH (muscular and tall) wearing headphones and KIARA YOUNG (Curvy, dark skin. Stretched afro).

ELIJAH
We're all good T. This is being
edited as we speak.

THEO JAGUAR
Perfect.

Theo turns back to the officers and smiles intensely at them. Their faces become uneasy. His face then turns to Kiara.

THEO JAGUAR (CONT'D)
You know what K. I know you've been
itching to dole out some justice. I
think i'm going to let you handle
this one.

Kiara smiles and nods. Elijah takes the man from Theo. Theo whispers to Kiara before he leaves.

THEO JAGUAR (CONT'D)
Make it quick.

Theo grabs the little girls hand. He proceeds to leave the scene with Elijah and the man and his family. Kiara's eyes suddenly have a yellow glow to them. Her aura becomes very yellow and she manifests a few golden spears. The officers start screaming. Blood is spattered on the floor.

INT. ZEMACULEAS POLICE DATA ROOM - DAY

The data room has holograms encircling it and sitting crosslegged in the middle of a room is ARGUS (African glowing tribal tattoo's throughout body, cables attached to head, green eyes, prosthetic arms that look like a power glove) and two men in army uniforms. The men are speaking to him. GENERAL #1 (Buzz cut, Tall, athletic build) is speaking in an angry tone while GENERAL #2 (Identical looking to #1) is staring with piercing eyes at the holograms around the room.

GENERAL #1
What do you mean you can't read
their DNA? You're our high tech
surveillance system and you
can't even do your goddamn job.

Argus speaks in a monotoned voice.

ARGUS
I can't understand this
discrepancy myself sir. I have
never had this huge of a margin of
error. This anomaly is baffling to
me as well.

General #2 asks the Argus to replay the footage. The footage shows the police officers being approached by hooded figures, the officers fire. They are then approached by a hooded figure. Two of the hooded figures walk away with the young woman, child, and bloodied man. The officers collapse and the screen goes to black. The screen then showcases the symbol of the black cloak society.

GENERAL #2
You know we can't let this get out,
right Argus.

ARGUS
I understand sir. What would you
like for the official edit?

General two inaudibly speaks and points to parts of the footage while Argus nods and moves his hands.

INT. ROYAL PALACE BALLROOM - NIGHT

A plethora of rich citizens in fine black-tie dress mingle amongst themselves in the ballroom, with KING TIBERIUS (20s, handsome, tall) at the forefront, smiling grandly but it doesn't quite reach his eyes.

COMMANDER ZADOK (20s, military uniform) approaches. He talks to Tiberius in a low voice.

COMMANDER ZADOK
Enjoying yourself, my
king?

KING TIBERIUS
Don't patronize me, brother.
It's my duty to attend these
things.

COMMANDER ZADOK
I'm aware. You have made
yourself quite clear on that
front.

KING TIBERIUS
You would do well to enjoy
yourself, Zadok. You may be
Zemacules top commander on every
other front but tonight you can
relax. It's a gala, after all.

COMMANDER ZADOK
I will relax when these...
infiltrators leave our precious
city.

KING TIBERIUS
Infiltrators?

Zadok clears his throat, seeming like he regrets bringing up the subject.

KING TIBERIUS (CONT'D)
Oh, don't hold your tongue now.
If there is something you wish to
discuss with me, spit it out.

COMMANDER ZADOK
You know whom I mean.

Tiberius leads them away from the crowd into a more sheltered corner of the ballroom.

KING TIBERIUS

Are you referring to the refugees?

COMMANDER ZADOK

They are hardly refugees. We...
you let them into our city. They
are taking the jobs of hard-
working Zemaculeans, if nothing to
say for the Traxulom trash who
leech from our kingdoms treasury!

Tiberius holds up a hand to silence Zadok.

KING TIBERIUS

I'd appreciate you minding
your tone. We are in the
presence of guests.

COMMANDER ZADOK

My apologies.

KING TIBERIUS

However, despite your prejudice,
you've brought up a good point
I've been meaning to discuss with
our council lately.

Tiberius begins to walk the length of the wall, beckoning
Zadok to follow him.

KING TIBERIUS (CONT'D)

It is time for change in our
nation, Zadok. Not only with our
immigration but with our social
classes.

COMMANDER ZADOK

I don't know what you mean.

KING TIBERIUS

We need social mobility. Our
current situation is really
only benefiting the richer class,
while we leave our poorer
citizens scrounging for scraps. The
terrorists capitalize on the
people's pain. I want to change
that. I want to give the people
hope through peaceful means.

Zadok stops in his tracks.

COMMANDER ZADOK

This will not sit well with
our more... influential
families.

KING TIBERIUS

I'm aware. But, we have allies,
do we not?

COMMANDER ZADOK

Our circle grows smaller each day.
But... Thelonius has proved to be
very influential among our social
circles.

The two brothers come back into the fray of the public,
Zadok seeming to search for Thelonius.

COMMANDER ZADOK (CONT'D)

(pointing)

There.

KING TIBERIUS

Thank you brother. You are
dismissed.

Zadok does a salute to his king and leaves to go mingle
with the others. Meanwhile, Tiberius approaches THELONIUS
(30s, black, rich attire) talking to a young aide. Thelonius
notices the king and bows.

THELONIUS

Your Majesty. To what do I
owe this honour?

KING TIBERIUS

At ease, Thelonius. There is a
matter I wish to discuss with
you.

THELONIUS

(Dismissing his aide)

Of course. What is it my king?

KING TIBERIUS

There are things in this country
I'd like to change and I need
your help convincing the council.
I hear you have some connections
among them.

THELONIUS

(Wary)

This is true. By what means do you wish to convince them?

KING TIBERIUS

I hear you have your methods. What matters is that I need them on my side.

THELONIUS

What kind of changes are you planning to implement?

INT. THEO JAGUAR RESIDENCE - NIGHT

Theo Jaguar's room is incredibly minimalist. There is a painting of a giant butterfly on the wall and a cityscape that looks different from Zamaculeas. Beneath the cityscape painting reads: "home".

The door creaks - enter Theo wearing a police uniform. He notices a paper note on his table and heads towards it. He opens the paper up and reads it.

INSERT: The paper reads: You've been requested for a new mission.

Suddenly yellow kunai knives start to fly at Theo. Theo throws black kunai knives back. Meeting each knife. Suddenly around his neck is a HOODED FIGURE with two yellow swords around his neck.

HOODED FIGURE

Got you.

THEO JAGUAR

Stalemate.

Two black Kunai knives are on the figures garment ready to pierce through the skin.

HOODED FIGURE

I would invest in better security if I were you.

Theo seems unfazed by the figures presence.

THEO JAGUAR

Have you ever heard of knocking?

HOODED FIGURE

I think we've known each other too long to have to do that.

Theo chuckles and smiles.

THEO JAGUAR

What up K?

Kiara removes her hood and daps (a form of handshake) Theo up.

KIARA

I'm aight. How's the husband doing?

THEO JAGUAR

He's doing okay. We got him resting in Kyoka's. Mom and daughter are being taken care of too.

KIARA

Lucky those were just average Capitol police scum. You might've had some real trouble with some of the secret manipulators. I saw you out there breaking a sweat.

Theo rolls his eyes.

THEO JAGUAR

Whatever helps you sleep at night princes. By the way if I was really trying in our fight right now. You'd be dead as hell.

KIARA

Come on Theo. Do I have to remind you whose top dawg. Cause you better believe i'll hand your ass to you just like last time.

THEO JAGUAR

(Mockingly)

"I'll hand your ass to you just like last time". Fuck off, you got lucky.

Theo gives Kiara the middle finger. Kiara returns the same gesture to him and they both start laughing.

They both dissolve their weapons and sit down across from each other.

THEO JAGUAR (CONT'D)
So what's this new mission?

Kiara's face becomes really serious.

KIARA
Brother Black says they may have
found the woman responsible for our
orphanage burning down.

Theo's eyes suddenly become emotionless and a tattoo
around his face appears revealing the Black Cloak Society
insignia.

THEO JAGUAR
When?

KIARA
Next 24 hours. You, Me, Elijah,
are going to be heading there. He
would prefer her alive but he knows
what this one means to us. So we
can kill her as long as we get her
government-issued obelisk for our
future plans.

THEO JAGUAR
I'll be ready.

Kiara stands up from her chair and starts to leave.

KIARA
I gotta get some rest before work
tomorrow so I need to get going.

THEO JAGUAR
Alright see ya, K.

Kiara daps Theo up and leaves.

INT. POLICE HEADQUARTERS DATA ROOM - NIGHT

The Argus works away, swiping at different videos of
people in the city. He brings up Theo's home footage.

INSERT: Theo sits on his couch, enjoying his dinner,
watching a square hologram. The video starts to glitch.

Commander Zadok lingers among the guests, standing stiffly at
attention. He smiles at those who greet him but looks
uncomfortable among them. BROTHER BLACK (Downturned amber
eyes, beefy body with obsidian skin, tribal tattoos and a
bald head) in civilian disguise approaches, saluting Zadok.

BROTHER BLACK
Commander.

COMMANDER ZADOK
At ease, soldier.

BROTHER BLACK
What a pleasure it is to see
you, sir. I've been meaning to
talk to you.

COMMANDER ZADOK
As have many.

An awkward moment passes between them.

BROTHER BLACK
You know I haven't come here
for pleasure.

COMMANDER ZADOK
Why not? It is a gala, after all.

BROTHER BLACK
And yet, here we both are.
Standing in the back room, keeping
up appearances...

COMMANDER ZADOK
What is it you want, soldier?

BROTHER BLACK
A moment of your time, sir. I
think you'll be interested in
what I have to say. Commander
Zadok ponders for a moment.

COMMANDER ZADOK
Very well. Come, soldier.
Let's talk away from prying
ears.

INT. PALACE TRAINING ROOM - THE NEXT DAY

NOTE: This entire scene is in American Sign Language (ASL)
but Kiara and Tiberius both speak out loud as well.

The sound of grunting and objects hitting against
blunt material can be heard down the hall.

A door opens to reveal PRINCESS YARA and her instructor, KIARA YOUNG, sparring together via a matter manipulation match, both their auras glowing as they breathe heavily, intensely staring at each other.

A bunch of rocks are floating around Kiara and Yara is standing in a defensive position. Tiberius enters, keeping a wide berth from the two women. He clears his throat, startling Kiara, who stops and waves to Yara, getting her attention. They both stop and bow to each other. Kiara proceeds to address the king.

KIARA

Your Majesty.

PRINCESS YARA

Tiberius. Why are you interrupting my session?

KING TIBERIUS

Is that any way to speak to your king?

PRINCESS YARA

No, but in this room, titles aren't allowed. If I'm going to fight properly, all formalities are off the table.

Kiara laughs beside her.

KIARA

You're right, Yara. But his Majesty trumps all rules for non-formality.

KING TIBERIUS

Please, I didn't wish to interrupt. Merely watch.

Yara shoots her middle finger at him as she signals for an attendant.

PRINCESS YARA

You creep. But, it does help to show you that I'm not as helpless as I was years ago. Come on, Kiara. And don't hold back this time.

KIARA

I never do.

The two women get back into their stances, auras glowing again. Kiara with a glowing blue aura sets herself up in an offensive position and Yara with a yellow aura sets herself up in a defensive stance. Kiara begins hurling the rocks at Yara.

Yara is able to catch the rocks with her aura and crush them. She moves into an offensive position and starts hurling light matter lightning bolts at Kiara. Kiara through a series of acrobatic moves is able to dodge the attacks. Yara signs a taunting message and creates a matter sword.

Kiara does the same and lunges at Yara. They trade intense blows. Kiara appears to have the upper hand in terms of strength and is able to knock Yara off balance with a parry and riposte.

Yara stumbles backwards, raising the matter sword with both hands while Kiara brings down strike after strike. The two end up near the wall, Tiberius watches with concern. Yara's back hits the wall, countering Kiara's matter sword with her own. And with force, she starts to push back.

Now it's Kiara's turn to stumble, and Yara strikes back harder and faster than Kiara, the two yelling out strained grunts.

In a final blow, Yara knocks Kiara over and the matter sword comes out of her hand, the instructor falling to the floor. They both pant with exhaustion. Yara helps her up.

KING TIBERIUS

Amazing! Little sister, you have grown.

KIARA

She has improved, I'll say. But she still has a long way to go before she can truly master her light matter gifts.

PRINCESS YARA

Oh, please. I'm more than ready.

KIARA

Oh yeah?

In an instant, Kiara, without any movement, is able to bring a blue aura underneath Yara who falls flat on her back, letting out a surprised sound.

KIARA (CONT'D)

That's what I thought.

She turns to King Tiberius.

KIARA (CONT'D)

The princess is strong but she still lacks in certain areas. If we can get her more training in between her duties, she can be that much more defended.

KING TIBERIUS

You may be right. I'll see what I can do.

Yara still lays flat on the floor, pouting. Tiberius lends her a hand which she waves away, getting up on her own.

PRINCESS YARA

That caught me off guard, Kiara. That wasn't fair.

KIARA

Yeah well, that's what real fighting is, princess. Your opponent isn't going to be as forgiving as I am. You need to be prepared and ready for any possibility.

In classic teenager fashion, Yara crosses her arms and rolls her eyes.

PRINCESS YARA

Then why can't you teach me that?

KIARA

You still need to master the basics. Once you do, you can modify them at will. You're strong, Yara, don't get me wrong but you still have that mentality that no one will harm a princess. Outside this ivory tower, people are ruthless. They don't care who you are.

PRINCESS YARA

Fine.

KING TIBERIUS

Thank you for your hard work, instructor. You are helping this family a great deal. I'm sure you've heard of the unrest within the nation.

Kiara bristles, crossing her arms.

KIARA

Oh, I've heard, your Majesty.
And they're becoming more than
whispers.

KING TIBERIUS

Let's hope it doesn't come to that.

He turns towards the princess.

KING TIBERIUS (CONT'D)

Great work, Yara. I can see
you've got a lot of fighter spirit
and strength. Soon, you'll be able
to beat even Zadok.

PRINCESS YARA

Please. I can beat Mr. Stick-up-
his- ass any day.

With that, Tiberius exits the room, leaving the two
women alone again.

PRINCESS YARA (CONT'D)

One more round?

INT. KYOKA'S NOODLES - DAY

Four members of the black cloak society rush in from the
rain, shaking off their wet coats. Their hoods come off
to reveal, Theo, KIARA, and ELIJAH.

Kiara and Elijah find a table near the back of the room
and Elijah presses a button that brings up a holographic
menu. Theo comes up to the table and waves to the KYOKA
at the bar.

THEO JAGUAR

Kyoka! What's good, man?

KYOKA

The usual for you, then?

THEO JAGUAR

You know it. Elijah's just
adding two more orders to my
tab.

KYOKA

You know, one of these days,
you're gonna have to pay for all
of this.

THEO JAGUAR

Well, lucky for you, I'll start
paying it off monthly. Kyoka
scoffs, but rings up the
orders.

KYOKA

When that day happens, I'll
retire happily.

Theo laughs and joins his friends at the table. Kiara
gives him a look of sarcastic disbelief.

KIARA

It's rude to give an old man
false hope, T.

THEO JAGUAR

Please, he doesn't even believe
me! But I do have the cash!

ELIJAH

Right. And we're the royal family.

Kiara snickers and Theo rolls his eyes.

THEO JAGUAR

Whatever. Y'all have no faith
in me.

Kyoka walks towards them with flying robots carrying
their drinks to the table. He whispers in Theo's ear then
leaves them swiftly to help another customer.

KIARA

You two meet this Nhyn guy yet?

Elijah shakes his head.

THEO JAGUAR

Who's Nhyn?

KIARA

God, you're dense. You know, the
tech guy? The one who's got
the I.D. on the next target?

Theo takes a moment to process, then...

THEO JAGUAR

Oh! Right. Him. No I haven't met him yet.

ELIJAH

Yeah, we got that, captain obvious.

THEO JAGUAR

Fuck both of you. You can kiss your free food goodbye.

Their food arrives and they dig in eagerly. A moment passes before an OLD MAN's bionic arm clasps Theo on the shoulder. Theo turns with a frown but grins when he sees who the arm belongs to.

THEO JAGUAR (CONT'D)

Look who it is, guys!

OLD MAN

It's good to see you kids again.

Elijah moves to give the old man space to sit down.

OLD MAN (CONT'D)

Thank you, Elijah. Never a man of words but a man of action.

Elijah smiles sheepishly.

KIARA

Things have changed since the old days. You should see the man when he talks strategy.

OLD MAN

Hidden talents aplenty, then. What have you kids been up to? It's been... oh, four years since I've last seen you all?

THEO JAGUAR

Keeping busy, helping the cause. You know how it is. What brings you here? I thought you retired.

OLD MAN

Thought I'd pay a visit to my old haunts. And maybe I was hoping to run into my favorite recruits too.

KIARA

Well, we're glad you're here. It's been too long. How have you been?

OLD MAN

Retired

(He sighs)

I miss being out in the action. But my old bones make me too much of a liability, I'm afraid.

KIARA

You're always welcome to visit the base. I'm sure our new recruits would be glad to hear from someone who's been in the action since its early days.

OLD MAN

You calling me old, Kiara?

KIARA

You said it, not me.

OLD MAN

Cheeky.

The old man takes a moment before getting out of his seat.

OLD MAN (CONT'D)

I'll leave you kids to it. It's good to see you again. Take care, now.

He pats Theo on the shoulder again before heading to the counter.

THEO JAGUAR

Have a good night, sir!

ELIJAH

Man, I forgot how much I missed him.

Kyoka makes his way back to the table.

KYOKA

He's ready for you.

Theo and their crew make their way into the back room of Kyoka's

INT. KYOKA'S NOODLES BACKROOM - CONTINUOUS

The walls of the room are made of stone and the room is lined with circuitry from top to bottom. Theo and crew step into the room and close their eyes. All three members of the team close their eyes. Their aura's start glowing and the circuitry lights up. A small hatch opens up from the floor. Theo, Kiara and Elijah get into three cryo chambers and are pulled down to the ground.

INT. UNDERGROUND BLACK CLOAK BASE - CONTINUOUS

The team of Theo, Kiara, and Elijah walk around the base with confidence. Around the base teachers are seen giving lectures about the society's teachings. In a red room individuals are sitting cross legged silently floating in the air. In a dojo area of the facility two young adults are engaged in a sparring match. In an area that mimics a prison yard a young woman is manipulating matter through hand movements.

Theo's face is hardened, his trail dead-set on a destination.

Kiara quickens her pace, joining Theo at his side. She bumps her side against his lightly.

KIARA

You okay?

THEO JAGUAR

(clipped)

Fine.

She rolls her eyes and turns her head to look at Elijah with an exasperated look. Eventually, the three make it to a closed room.

Theo swipes his hand over the biometric hand-lock and the door hisses open.

INT. BLACK CLOAK SOCIETY HEADQUARTERS - CONTINUOUS

The interior of the black cloak society headquarters could be described as an organized mess. There is a blackboard filled with holographic images and red lines crossing over all of them.

There are small robots flitting everywhere, making repairs to old objects and plastering holographic posters on the walls.

Many hunched figures loom over holographic keyboards, typing furiously.

BROTHER BLACK sits atop the group, reading over lines that circle around his head. Theo clears his throat and Brother Black looks up.

BROTHER BLACK
My brothers! And sister. To what
do I owe this visit?

Theo and Kiara move into the room together, Elijah lingering at the door's entrance. He takes the headphones around his neck to his ears.

THEO JAGUAR
(Annoyed)
You know why we're here.

BROTHER BLACK
Yes brother J. I understand you
have an aim to achieve revenge and
I am your salvation.

THEO JAGUAR
Is she the one?

Brother black grins sinisterly at Theo and chuckles.

BROTHER BLACK
Glad to see you've kept your hate
alive brother J. Embracing darkness
is the only pathway to achieving
light.

Theo just stares impatiently at Brother Black. Brother Black meets his gaze. A man in a suit walks over and whispers into brother blacks ear.

BROTHER BLACK (CONT'D)
Your answer lies over there.

Brother black points to an individual at the front of the room. NHYN (20s, dreadlocks, lean, mixed race (black and Asian) has his eyes trained on the floating screen in front of him. The crew makes their way over to him.

BROTHER BLACK (CONT'D)
Brother J. May this journey of
justice bring some peace to your
downcast soul.

INSERT: The screen blips with facial recognition software, faces and information blending together in quick succession. Kiara enters the room first, Theo and Elijah trailing behind her.

NHYN
Are you NHYN?

Without looking away from his screen, Nhyn waves his hand up. Kiara levels a look at her two friends and they join Nhyn at his computer.

KIARA
We 're here to debrief with you?

NHYN
Uh huh.

THEO JAGUAR
Look, man, what's the holdup?
You got answers or what?

NHYN
Patience, grasshopper. I'm getting there.

ELIJAH
Please excuse our fearless leader.
He's a little on edge.

Theo rolls his eyes and Kiara swats his arm.

KIARA
Is it almost ready, though?

NHYN
Just... Give me one... second...
Okay! We've got her!

INSERT: The computer screens blur of faces stops abruptly, landing on RUTH MAZNIKE (Golden Hair), her personal information displayed as well with a map of her last known location.

Theo takes a deep breath in.

INT. BLACK CLOAK UNDERGROUND BASE - CONTINUOUS

Theo rushes out of the black cloak society command centre, Kiara and Elijah hot on his heels. Kiara makes an annoyed sound and grabs Theo by the shoulder, turning him around.

KIARA
Theo, stop being fucking broody.
You're obviously not fine!

Theo shrugs off her hand and makes a noncommittal grunt.

KIARA (CONT'D)

You're so stupid. You think you're the only one suffering? This is the lady who set our home on fire!

ELIJAH

We all saw it. Not just you, T. You can talk to us if you want.

THEO JAGUAR

There's nothing to talk about. It's fine. I'm fine. Let's just focus on the damn mission.

Theo clenches his fists, his aura manifesting and slowly growing in size.

ELIJAH

You're a real treat when you're pissed. Just try not to break any more robots.

INT. BLACK CLOAK TRAINING ROOM - LATER

SMASH! A nearby robot gets thrown against the wall and the pieces fly everywhere.

Theo pants heavily, his aura growing while Kiara and Elijah stare at him warily.

ELIJAH (CONT'D)

(dryly)

Please, keep smashing the robots. It's not like we have unlimited parts to fix 'em with.

Kiara groans and taps Elijah on the shoulder, bringing herself down in a fighting stance.

KIARA

Leave him be. He'll get back on track soon enough. Now, hit me with your best shot, pretty boy.

Elijah immediately gets into position, willing his aura to surface around him. Kiara matches the size of his aura with her own.

ELIJAH

I'm not pretty.

KIARA

Sure you are.

The two spar with quick jabs of power and manifestations of weapons. Their auras grow larger and smaller depending on how much power they're using.

Theo eventually joins the group, chatting quietly with members who come in and out of the training room while watching Kiara and Elijah spar. He whistles for both of them to join him.

ELIJAH

Finally ready to punch out your emotions? You know that's unhealthy.

THEO JAGUAR

Hardy har har. Shut up. I talked to Black to figure out how we're going to remain undetected during the mission and he told me there's an ally willing to cover for us. But we have to check in with Nhyn first. He's got the compound map ready for us.

INT. BLACK CLOAK SOCIETY HEADQUARTERS - LATER

There's an array of chairs facing a large hologram screen with Nhyn flittering around it, summoning a keyboard and typing random things.

INSERT: The hologram shows a map of a large mansions compound. There are small red blips fading in and out, moving around the map like placeholders for people.

Theo, Kiara, and Elijah make themselves known and Nhyn startles before clapping his hands in delight.

NHYN

Sit down, sweaty people! It's time for the location run-down.

THEO JAGUAR

Since when do you give run-downs?

NHYN

There's a lot you don't know about me, fearless leader. Now, shut up and put those listening ears on. Ruth Maznike's compound is a doozy.

He turns back to the hologram, swiping at it to reveal a map of the city. The three friends take a seat. Kiara watches intensely, Theo looks bored and Elijah quietly tinkers with an old device.

NHYN (CONT'D)

There's an underground tunnel system somewhere in the city that leads directly to the compound. We suspect it's somewhere around here.

He gestures in the general vicinity of the middle-class area of the city.

NHYN (CONT'D)

We've already got scouts patrolling as you can see by the red dots but I'm sure once we get closer, you three will figure it out. Capiche?

Everyone nods in understanding which causes Nhyn to smile and swipe at the hologram again.

NHYN (CONT'D)

Once you get through that little tunnel system, you'll get to her compound. It's heavily armed with security so be extra careful setting off any alarms. But you'll be coming out of the gutters and into here!

He smacks the hologram, disturbing the image for a second before stabilizing.

NHYN (CONT'D)

That's her garden. The weakest point of entry and you can be easily hidden with her lovely array of topiaries. From then, you can get started on the inside of the house, which is pretty straightforward. Questions?

THEO JAGUAR

Yeah. When will we know the general location? I don't like going in blind.

NHYN

I'll let you know as soon as we do.

THEO JAGUAR

Good.

All three of them get up simultaneously, startling Nhyn. He clears his throat as they start to leave.

NHYN

You guys have a timetable of when
you're doing this?

THEO JAGUAR

We plan on going tomorrow night
once we get word from our ally.

Nhyn makes a small noise and he nods. Theo manages a small
smile.

THEO JAGUAR (CONT'D)

Thanks, Nhyn. That wasn't a bad run-
down as far as they go.

EXT. THELONIUS HOUSE - THE NEXT DAY - EVENING

The home OF Thelonius is quite modest in its
neighborhood of mansions. It's lavish in its decoration but
lacks in size.

The team of three cautiously make their way to the entrance.
Theo flicks his wristwatch upwards, bringing up a square
hologram.

THEO JAGUAR (CONT'D)

This should be the address.

Kiara looks over Theo's shoulder to the hologram.

INSERT: Thelonius cordially invites Theo Jaguar and
company to his domain at [ADDRESS] in the Middle Ring at 6
o'clock.

KIARA

You sure we can trust this guy?

THEO JAGUAR

Black says we can trust him and
that guy doesn't trust anybody.

KIARA

If you're sure, then lead the way.

Theo leads the way to the front door, cautiously ringing the
doorbell. It causes a scuffle of technology, a large camera
operated by an arm zooms quickly onto their three faces. A
VOICE (crackled, male) booms through the speakers.

VOICE

Identification, please.

THEO JAGUAR

Theo Jaguar and company? We got
your holo?

He raises the hologram on his wrist into the cameras vision.
It backs away, the doors hissing open, revealing a brightly
lit entryway.

VOICE

You may enter and wait for your
host.

INT. THELONIUS HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

The inside of the house is more of an indication of Thelonius
wealth. There are dozens of small robots milling around up
and down the stairs, through rooms and little crannies. Some
of them are cleaning, others are scanning and others are
bringing around trays of food.

Theo steps into the fray, Kiara and Elijah flanking his
sides. Elijah looks up in wonder at the robots, taking
pictures with a tap of his thumb and forefinger.

THELONIUS (O.S.)

Impressive, aren't they?

The three turn to see Thelonius holding his hands behind his
back, smiling at Elijah.

ELIJAH

Did you build them all yourself?

THELONIUS

Mostly. Had some help from some
very talented engineers, of course.
But they're all mine.

He extends a hand out to the three of them, who shake it
each in turn.

THELONIUS (CONT'D)

Thelonius Jacoby, at your service.
Which one of you is Mr. Jaguar?

Theo stands tall at attention and Kiara snorts.

THEO JAGUAR

That would be me, sir. I'm guessing
your invitation wasn't to have us
for dinner?

THELONIUS

No. But my pets will bring you food
as we go along. Come with me.

Thelonius waves to all of them to follow him down the hallway
and downstairs.

INT. THELONIUS HOUSE - BASEMENT - CONTINUOUS

The basement is basically a giant lab. Blue light emanates
from every corner and there are transparent cylinders holding
mannequins. A human-sized scanner device sits in the middle
of the room.

THELONIUS (CONT'D)

Welcome to my lab. Make yourselves
comfortable.

Elijah stands shell-shocked by what he sees. His smile
grows bigger and bigger. Theo and Kiara look around the lab
with wonder.

ELIJAH

This is sick, man! No wonder you
come highly recommended!

THELONIUS

Thanks, kid. But it's not much to
look at. At work, I've got a much
bigger space.

Kiara wanders around the room, staring intently at the
mannequins.

KIARA

What're these for?

THELONIUS

That would be your place-holders
for the genome sequence.

KIARA

(Shocked)

You know how to use the genome
sequence?

Thelonius smiles smugly.

THELONIUS

That's how you're gonna stay
undetected from the Argus.

(MORE)

THELONIUS (CONT'D)

The scanner in the middle there
will make you look exactly as you
are and while you're on your
mission, you'll have a solid alibi
in case the pigs start sniffing.

ELIJAH

Holy shit, man!

THEO JAGUAR

Had to deal with a genome issue
once. How can you be so sure it's
reliable?

THELONIUS

Ah yes, the actress. Famous case
you worked on, Jaguar. But I can
guarantee it won't get to that.

He strides over to the mannequins and taps on the glass.

THELONIUS (CONT'D)

These bad boys don't have brains or
conscience. They're just robots who
will happen to look like you.
They'll move around and talk but
it's just random dialogue I've
programmed into them. Nothing to
worry about.

Theo stares at Thelonius suspiciously before shrugging and
backing off. Elijah eagerly inspects every piece of equipment
around the lab while Kiara keeps staring suspiciously at the
mannequins.

A blip from Theo's wristwatch alerts him. He flicks his
wrist and an image of Nhyn pops up on the screen.

NHYN

Oh good you guys are almost ready.
We got the location centered on the
underground entrance. I'll send you
the coordinates ASAP.

THEO JAGUAR

Thanks, man.

He flicks his wrist again and the picture disappears. Another
blip from the watch and Theo stares at it quickly.

THEO JAGUAR (CONT'D)

Guys, we got the location. We
should be moving now.

Thelonius heads over to the scanner and types at the computer. In a few seconds, the scanner powers up, whirring with machine noises.

THELONIUS

She's up and running for you three.
Whoever's going first, get in.

Immediately, Elijah rushes into the scanner, waving his hands in excitement.

THELONIUS (CONT'D)

Stand there for a bit while we get
you scanned up.

There are lasers scanning up and down Elijah's body, and across the room, a mannequin begins to copy what Elijah looks like.

ELIJAH

Holy shit that's me! Genomes are so
cool!

KIARA

I'm so going next!

Once the mannequin is finished, the scanner stops its lasers and powers down for a second, allowing Elijah to step out. He runs to his mannequin and admires it.

Kiara laughs and steps slowly into the scanner. The same thing happens to her and her mannequin begins to exhibit her features and clothing little by little. She smiles the whole time.

Thelonius face is amused once Kiara's scan is finished.

THELONIUS

See? Nothing to be worried about,
Mr Jaguar. Step right up.

With reluctance, Theo steps up into the scanner and stays still the whole time, watching the mannequin with intense eyes.

THELONIUS (CONT'D)

Now that's all done, I'll release
your robot clones into the living
room and you'll be good to go!

KIARA

It's that easy? I thought genomes
were seriously complicated.

THELONIUS

For humans, it is. With robots, not so much. They're just vessels and genome sequencing is like putting clothes on them.

KIARA

Huh. Cool.

With a nod, Thelonius goes to each cylinder holding the mannequin and releases each of them. Their eyes open and glow blue before going to each persons eye colour.

They're almost organic in the way that they move and they follow Thelonius upstairs, the real crew following.

INT. THELONIUS HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS

The real crew stays behind and out of the way of the security camera locked into the corner of the ceiling while Thelonius commands the robots to sit comfortably in the chairs.

THELONIUS

(While looking at the robots)

You guys will find an exit in the basement that'll bring you out the back entrance. Follow that road out and you'll be good to go to get to your mission.

THEO JAGUAR

Thanks a lot for your help, Thelonius.

THELONIUS

Good luck, kids.

INT. SECURITY GUARD ROOM - NIGHT

Two security guards lounge around when the sensor suddenly goes off. One of the security guards watching the cameras: MALCOLM (43, light skin, buff) notices the screen pinging with an alarm..

INSERT: The screen reads: "ALARM TRIGGERED BY UNKNOWN MOVEMENT". Malcolm rewinds the screen to find nothing has happened.

Making a confused noise, he radioes another guard: SIMON (35, light skin, dreadlocks, buff).

MALCOLM

(Radio Noise)

Hey Simon, I just got a strange alarm from the courtyard. Probably nothing but could you check it out? Over.

EXT. MAZNIKE COMPOUND -CONTINUOUS

SIMON

(Radio Blip)

Copy that. 10-4 checking the premises now.

Simon walks towards the courtyard and looks around. He notices something on the ground and picks it up. It's Theo's capitol police badge. He proceeds to call Simon back.

SIMON (CONT'D)

(Radio Noise)

No sign of someone here, but I did find something strange on the ground. It's a-

INT. SECURITY GUARD ROOM - CONTINUOUS

MALCOLM

Simon? Hello? What did you find?

EXT. MAZNIKE COMPOUND - CONTINUOUS

A group of 20 security guards makes its way to the front of the compound to find three hooded figures standing there with Simon's dead body on the ground. SECURITY GUARD #1 (Short, dark skinned, stoic) radios Malcolm.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER

(Radio Noise)

We found Simon. He's been taken out. We will be engaging the threat.

MALCOLM

Copy that I'll be sending in backup.

The security guards start shooting at the three figures but their bullets dissolve through some invisible force field. We see Theo using his hands to manipulate figures in front of him and the two other figures to look like monsters.

INT. SECURITY GUARD ROOM - DAY

There are screams on the radio. Malcolm clutches his radio with a death-like grip

MALCOLM (CONT'D)

(Panicked)

Hello Alpha squad! Come in Alpha squad! There's a disturbance at the front gate. Please check the premises and be prepared to use deadly force if necessary! And hurry!

INT. MAZNIKE RESIDENCE SECURITY COMPOUND - NIGHT

A SECURITY TEAM MEMBER (Tall, dark skinned) already in SWAT gear with the insignia of Zemaucles answers the radio call.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER

(Radio Noise)

Copy that.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER (CONT'D)

Alpha squad team preparing to move in. Over and out!

(Radio Noise)

Let's go, team!

MONTAGE: A group of 10 members prepare themselves by gearing up in a locker room before moving to another room to grab heavy duty guns. They make their way towards the front.

INT. SECURITY GUARD ROOM - NIGHT

Malcolm proceeds to call the main house, his eyes glued to the security cameras.

INT. MAZNIKE BEDROOM - CONTINUOUS

A sleeping Ruth is startled awake by the incessant buzzing from her device. She waves her hand to open the hologram, tapping the "ANSWER" prompt.

RUTH

Malcolm, do you realize what time it is?

MALCOLM

Sorry to wake you, Ma'am but I believe we have a security threat on the premises.

(MORE)

MALCOLM (CONT'D)

I called in the Alpha squad but I'm going to need you to evacuate in case the threat is greater than we thought. This may seem drastic but I'm executing security plan 124-A and also contacting the Argus to send back-up. Zike and his group will escort you and your family to safety while we investigate further.

RUTH

Understood.

Zike a very stern-faced (Tall, dark skinned, athletic build) walks into the room with an earpiece. She waves the hologram away and gets out of bed, opening the door to: ZIKE (tall, dark skinned, athletic build) who stands at attention, gesturing to his earpiece)

ZIKE

The helicopter is on the way for you and your family. Come with us, please.

EXT. MAZNIKE COMPOUND - NIGHT

Theo, Kiara, and Elijah take out the last of the guards and make their way to the house.

Before they get there, a group of Alpha squad members pull up in a futuristic Humvee. A SECURITY TEAM MEMBER (in uniform, face covered by a helmet) comes out of the car slowly and notices the dead bodies strewn across the lawn.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER

(Radio Noise)

Casualties all over. Engage with deadly force upon encounter. Over and out.

The rest of the team shuffles out of the Humvee, ready for battle.

INT. POLICE DATA ROOM - NIGHT

The Argus is sitting in a room looking over security footage when he gets a notification via his system.

INSERT: It reads Malcolm Mafonye.

The Argus answers with a flick of his finger. The hologram of Malcom appears in front of Argus. His face is panicked, sweat lining his brow.

ARGUS

Hello Malcolm, how can I assist you this evening.

MALCOLM

There is a disturbance over at the Maznike residence. We need back-up.

ARGUS

How peculiar... Nothing of yet has come up for me in regard to the Maznike residence. But I will send some Capitol police your way.

MALCOLM

No! These guys have already taken out about 20 guards! I sent out the Alpha squad and I'm watching their body cam footage. We need government manipulators! Now!

ARGUS

As you wish.

Argus dismisses Malcolm's hologram and proceeds to call up holograms of three teenagers dressed in uniforms with government insignia: ANIKO (half black, half Asian, short woman) a JAMIKEH (dark-skinned, male), and ZARA (dark-skinned woman).

ARGUS (CONT'D)

There is a disturbance at the Maznike residence. Deal with it promptly and as... cleanly as possible.

ANIKO

We will be there shortly, sir.

INT. MAZNIKE COMPOUND - NIGHT

Alpha squad has moved in with guns drawn. Four of the members of the team have activated their matter auras, holding themselves in defensive stances.

Quiet greets them until a small toy bounces down a marble staircase. The team stops to stare at the toy until a hooded figure comes out of the darkness. On instinct, they start shooting at the matter-monster but nothing happens. One of the members raises his hand.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER
Cease fire!

The team stops firing; a showdown between them and the matter- monster. The team member steps towards the monster.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER (CONT'D)
You must be one of those Black
Cloak freaks. I've been waiting for
a real challenge around here. You
have no idea how glad I am
that you showed up.

The monster growls, almost a mechanical sound.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER (CONT'D)
You see, we've got our own trained
matter manipulators here. And
they've been training all their
lives to bring terrorists like
you down!
(Pause)
Alpha squad elite manipulators?
Prepare yourselves.

Five of the members of the Alpha squad stalk towards the dark veiled monster and begin punching out matter attacks, their auras glowing. The monster is unfazed, but the security team member laughs lowly.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER (CONT'D)
I had a feeling that might
not work. Eh, but here's to
experiments. Execute tactic
73B!

The manipulators increase the intensity of their auras and run towards the matter monster, but the monster easily evades each attack.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER (CONT'D)
Shit. We're not doing any
damage. Team X full strength.

The members increase the intensity of their auras even more, firing larger blasts harder and quicker. Still unfazed, the creature stops its run, the growl turning into a warbled feminine voice.

KIARA
Finally, this is what I've
been waiting for.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER
OH! So you do speak.

KIARA
I was just waiting for you guys
to up the ante before I could
squash you like the ants you are!

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER
I wouldn't underestimate my team if
I was you.

KIARA
Well then... give me all you got
"team."

The team fires an intense array of matter attacks at Kiara who effortlessly dodges all of them. Their attacks dwindle in intensity after a while but they fire regardless.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER
Shit!
(Radio Noise)
Malcolm! Where the hell are
those government manipulators.

INT. GOVERNMENT VEHICLE - NIGHT

The three government manipulators are seen in a vehicle on the way to the compound. Two of them are playing a floating board game similar to chess while Aniko stares out the window at the synthetic moon.

INT. MAZNIKE COMPOUND - NIGHT

The Alpha squad manipulators aura's have now dissipated, Kiara unharmed and unfazed.

KIARA
That's really all you guys got?
Come on! I thought this would be
a fun time. Clearly they haven't
been trained well. Poor little
doggies.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER
Oh, don't worry, little lady.
We've got one more trick up
our sleeves.

The security team member pulls out a gigantic gun that reads anti-matter and shoots at Kiara with it. She ends up growing in size and smiles, rolling her shoulders nonchalantly.

KIARA
Why, thank you for the
energy boost, boys!

Kiara's large form looms over the Alpha squad and her smile glints in the darkness of her hood.

KIARA (CONT'D)
My turn.

Kiara lunges quickly at the manipulators and easily takes them out as they helplessly try to attack. One by one, she takes out the rest of Alpha squad until the security team member is left.

SECURITY TEAM MEMBER
(Shaking)
You terrorists won't win
this fight! This isn't over,
Black Cloak!

KIARA
Oh, but it is.

Kiara kills the guard before her form shrinks to her regular size. A slow clap echoes in the room, and Aniko, flanked by her two teammates, comes out into the light.

Kiara stops in her tracks, but says nothing.

ANIKO
Look at that. You won't even take a
bow? Cute. Why don't you take off
that cloak so we can see your real
face, honey.

KIARA
Nah i'd rather not.

Kiara lunges at Aniko. But is abruptly stopped. Aniko laughs.

ANIKO
Oh please, amateur hour is over
Black Cloak. I know you can do
better than that.

Jamekeh and Zara move in. The two government manipulators without auras are able to create matter weapons. They move towards Kiara and Jamekeh manipulates the stone around him to create a matter weapon to swing at Kiara.

Elijah suddenly jumps in, using object manipulation and creates a matter weapon to stop the attack.

ELIJAH

We finally, got the real deal.

ANIKO

Ahh perfect so there's two of you. Is there a third hiding there somewhere? Cause it wouldn't be fair, two against one.

Theo bursts out of his spot and quickly envelopes Aniko in dark matter. Aniko falters, releasing Kiara from her hold.

KIARA

What the hell was that?

THEO JAGUAR

She's a Corporeal manipulator.
Don't look into her eyes.

Zara proceeds to showcase a golden aura and dissolves Theo's dark matter bubble with a wave of her arms. Kiara laughs but goes into a fighting stance.

KIARA

Looks like you've met your match.

Jamekeh and Elijah begin trading blows with their matter weapons and move away from the other members. Jamekeh attacks erratically and appears stronger than Elijah. He starts to break Elijah's matter sword and towers over Elijah.

JAMEKEH

You've fought valiantly and I respect a man who does not fear death. Attempting to take on a warrior of the crown is not an easy task.

Elijah's hood has fallen off of his head, revealing an amused expression on his face.

JAMEKEH (CONT'D)

May you find peace in the next life, young warrior.

ELIJAH

I'm older than you! Get a grip, man!

FLASHBACK MONTAGE: The scene rewinds and we see Elijah's eyes watching Jamekah's movements. He swings erratically.

Elijah looks and notices that the shield disappears for 30 seconds at a time.

ELIJAH (V.O.)

(Internal Monologue)

He doesn't appear to have fully mastered the aura shield. If I can time my matter attack in the correct 30 second interval, I can get the upper hand

PRESENT: Jamekeh's matter shield disappears, and Elijah suddenly creates a matter spear which goes through Jamekeh's body in one quick move. Jamekeh falls to the ground, dead.

Elijah gets up and joins the others, who have now gone up the stairs to the main bedroom.

INT. MAZNIKE BEDROOM - NIGHT

Kiara and Theo stand before Aniko and Zara. Theo coats his and Kiara's eyes with dark matter and they stand before the two.

ANIKO

Well, look at that, Zara! We've finally met two worthy opponents! We may die in here. You willing to take that chance?

Zara nods, creating a large golden aura, Aniko following with her own. They get bigger and bigger.

THEO JAGUAR

Kiara! You planning on dying today?

KIARA

You must be out of your goddamn mind! If I die, I'm killing you.

Theo and Kiara both start manifesting larger auras to match the other two. Zara creates a light matter lightning bolt and hurls it at Theo. Theo creates a dark matter bolt and hurls it back and the two cancel each other out.

ANIKO

Impressive! Nobody's ever been able to match Zara's light matter powers before. You must be a truly exceptional matter user.

Kiara sighs irritatingly.

KIARA

Come on. Don't inflate this guys
ego! His heads already way to
big. Come at me, bitch!

Theo does an African lip smack of disapproval.

THEO JAGUAR

Can't let me have anything huh K.
How you gonna come at me when
you fell under her corporeality.

KIARA

Bitch won't catch me slipping
twice.

Aniko's eyes begin to glow as she runs at Kiara's matter
monster. Kiara attempts to grab her but Aniko is too
quick and nimble.

ANIKO

Play time is over little girl.
Time to show you what the adults
can do.

KIARA

Pfft... adults, aren't you
about four feet, bitch please.

Aniko's aura grows as she runs at Kiara's matter monster.
Kiara attempts to grab her but Aniko is too quick and
nimble. Aniko pulls out kunai knives dipped in a blue
glowing substance and hurls them at Kiara. Kiara attempts
to dodge them but is clipped by a Kunai. This creates a
flash bomb that knocks Kiara back and slowly dissolves the
dark matter.

Theo attempts to attack Aniko who has sped quickly away
from the explosion and creates a dark matter spear and
hurls it. Simultaneously Zara's aura becomes stronger, and
she creates light matter whip that is able to grab hold of
Theo's spear and hurl it back at him. Theo quickly dodges
the spear. Suddenly he sees a Kunai coming from straight
at him.

ANIKO

Bulls eye.

Another flashbang happens and Theo is thrust through a
wall into some rubble. Just then Elijah comes into the
room with his headphones. He sees Kiara without a matter
shield. But with a cloak concealing her identity.

ANIKO (CONT'D)

Zara finish the dark matter
boy off. He's our biggest threat
right now. I'll deal with the one
that just rushed in.

Zara envelopes herself in a light matter shield and makes
her way to Theo. Aniko turns to face Elijah.

ELIJAH

Mind control chick... Great...
probably should let you know
you should probably check on
your little buddy back there.

ANIKO

(Annoyed)

Can't say i'm surprised. Jamekah
was always our weakest link.

Aniko stares at Elijah who suddenly stops and has a blank
stare. She runs at him and gets close to him with a Kunai
in hand. Suddenly Elijah's eyes begin to glow and change
shape into an African pattern. Aniko immediately jumps
back.

ELIJAH

What's wrong? I thought we were
doing cool eye tricks. Don't
you want to see what I can do?

ANIKO

So, you guys have some tricks
up your sleeves, lovely.

Suddenly a dark matter Aura begins appearing out of
the rubble that Theo was incased in.

THEO JAGUAR

(Mutters)

Theo has built himself a dark matter shield in the rubble.
There is still no aura coming from him. But he still
throws the rubble straight at Zara. Zara is able to
dissolve it all except for one dark matter pebble that
get's stuck on her shield. The pebble won't come off and the
dark matter begins to grow all over her body. Zara sternly
stares at Theo unfazed.

ANIKO

It'll take more than that to deal
with my sister.

(MORE)

ANIKO (CONT'D)

Now for you, the most interesting member of this group. I thought I was the only member of the clan that survived.

Elijah and Aniko run at each other and fight hand to hand.

INT. MAZNIKE HELICOPTER PAD - NIGHT

Zike and two other security members are with Ruth and her husband and children.

ZIKE

Helicopter incoming ma'am. You and your family will be safe soon.

They wince as they here crashes and attacks below. Ruth looks up and sees a helicopter in the distance.

INT. MAZNIKE BEDROOM - NIGHT

Theo rises up with 4 black matter tentacles and attacks Zara very quickly. His attack is so forceful that he ends up sending her flying outside of the house.

Aniko and Elijah continue to square off inside of the house. Aniko throws Kunai's that Elijah dodges. Elijah increases his speed and is able to affectively do damage to Aniko. She get's very weary from the attacks in different directions and eventually falls to the ground. Theo arrives to Elijah just as she's knocked down

THEO JAGUAR

Looks like you've got this handled
i'm going for the main target. You
make sure Kiara's okay.

ELIJAH

Got it T.

Theo and Elijah hear a helicopter and Theo rushes with the four tentacles up to the roof.

INT. MAZNIKE HELICOPTER PAD - NIGHT

The helicopter lands on the pad just as Theo has gotten up. Ruth's family and two of the guards have made themselves inside. Ruth starts to make her way in when a dark matter tentacle grabs her. Zike jumps in after her. But another tentacle pushes him back in. Ruth yells.

RUTH

Zike take my family to safety.

ZIKE

But ma'am!

RUTH

Go!

Zike has a reluctant look on his face but he straps in. Ruth's family tries to protest.

ZIKE

Let's go!

The helicopter flies away and Theo brings Ruth to his face.

THEO JAGUAR

General Ruth Maznike, you are wanted for war crimes against the Traxulom people. Hundreds of Traxulom children slaughtered by you. What do you have to say for yourself?

RUTH

You have to understand young man. I was just following orders. If I didn't do it someone else would've.

THEO JAGUAR

You murdered children Ruth, you can't excuse that as just following orders. What the hell is wrong with you.

Ruth has a pleading look on her face she cries and looks at Theo.

RUTH

Please I have my own children now. I don't want them to live in a world without a mother. I beg of you, if you just let me go. I can make things right.

THEO JAGUAR

Enough, now is the time you pay for your crimes

Theo shoots a dark matter tentacle through Ruth's chest and she falls to the ground. He reverts back to his normal self reaches into Ruth's pocket and pulls out an Obelisk. Just then Elijah comes onto the roof with Kiara and Aniko bounded up and blindfolded.

THEO JAGUAR (CONT'D)
It's done. Time to move onto
the next phase.

Theo motions to Elijah to come near him.

THEO JAGUAR (CONT'D)
Did you bring it?

Elijah hands Aniko to Kiara. He pulls out a case and hands it to Theo. Theo opens the case and inside finds a flair gun. He proceeds to shoot it in the air.

EXT. ZEMACULEAS SKYLINE - DAY

As the artificial sunrise is happening in Zemaculeas. A bunch of colorful flares are being shot into the sky.

MONTAGE: In the countryside people see the flares. In the rich areas people wake up seeing the flares. Government forces come in and check on Jamekeh who appears to have a heartbeat. Zara encased in dark matter is placed inside a special box by scientists at the scene. Theo and crew have Aniko with them in a car. Theo looks at an obelisk device. The royal family quietly sits together at a dinner table. Yara points at the flares in the sky. Tiberius looks out with unease on his face. Tiberius has a mischievous smile on his face. Black cloak members are standing with hoods before a large menacing figure with a giant cloak.

EXT. KYOKA'S NOODLES - NIGHT

Kiara's phone starts ringing. No caller id shows up, she picks up.

KIARA
Hello?

MYSTERIOUS VOICE
Zeta, Alpha. Nine Nine.
Reporting for duty.

Kiara's eyes roll over and her demeanor changes. She walks out and disappears into the night.

FADE TO BLACK.

FIN